Common Presentation Phrases

Introduction Phrases:

- Good morning/afternoon/evening, everyone, welcome to [name of event]
- First, let me introduce myself. I am [name] from [company].
- Let me start by giving you some background information…
- Today I'm here to talk to you about…
- I'm delighted to be here today to discuss…
- Today I would like to outline our plans for…
- Firstly I'll talk about…
- Let's look at the first item on the agenda…
- So, to get the ball rolling…
- As you're aware, …
- I'll start with some general information on…Then I will look at or then we'll go over…
- I will be glad to answer any questions that you may have at the end of this presentation.
- Hello, everyone. I'd like, first of all, to thank the organizers of this meeting for inviting me here today.
- Good morning everyone and welcome to my presentation. First of all, let me thank you all for coming here today.
- Good morning, ladies and gentlemen. It's an honour to have the opportunity to address such a distinguished audience.
- Hallo/Hi everyone. Thanks for coming.

Introducing yourself (name, position, responsibilities)

- Let me introduce myself. I'm Jan Novak from Masaryk University in Brno, Czech Republic...
- Let me start by saying just a few words about my own background. I'm a PhD student of Geography at Masaryk
- University in Brno, Czech Republic.
- For those of you who don't know me already, my name's ... and I'm responsible for...

Saying what your topic/title/subject is

- What I'd like to present to you today is...
- As you can see on the screen, our topic today is...
- The subject/focus/topic/title of my presentation/talk/speech is...
- In this talk, I/we would like to concentrate on...
- In my presentation I would like to report on...
- I'm here today to present...

Explaining why your topic is relevant for your audience

- Today's topic is of particular interest to those of you who...
- My talk is particularly relevant to those of you who...
- By the end of this talk you will be familiar with...

Stating your purpose/objective

- The purpose/objective/aim of this presentation is to...
- Today I'd like to give you an overview of...
- I'd like to update you on/inform you about/put you in the picture about/give you the background to/present the results of my research...
- During the next 20 minutes we'll be...
- This talk is designed to act as a springboard for discussion.
- This morning I'm going to be talking to you about/ telling you about/ showing you how to deal with/ taking a look at the recent development in/ reporting on the results of the study we carried out...
- What I'm going to do/What I intend to do is describe to you/show you/tell you about...

Presenting the outline/organization/structure of your presentation

- I've divided my presentation into three main parts.
- In my presentation I'll focus on three major issues.
- We thought it would be useful to divide our talk into three main sections.
- We can break this area down into the following fields:...
- The subject can be looked at under the following headings:...
- We have organized this talk in the following way:...
- This presentation is structured as follows:...
- This talk will cover two current theories on the topic of...

Sequencing

- My first point concerns...
- I'll begin/start off by... Then I'll move on to... Then/Next/After that, I'll be looking at...
- First/First of all, I'd like to give you an overview of...
- Secondly/Then/Next, I'll focus on...
- Thirdly/And then, we'll consider...
- Finally/Lastly/Last of all, I'll deal with...
- So, I'll begin by filling you in on the background to/ bringing you up-to-date on/ giving you an overview of the history of/ making a few observations about/ outlining...
- And then, I'll go on to highlight what I see as the main points of/ put the situation into some kind of perspective/discuss in more depth the implications of/ take you through/make detailed recommendations regarding...
- One thing I'll be dealing with is the issue of...
- I'll end with...
- And finally, I'd like to address the problem of/to raise briefly the issue of...

Questions

- If you have any questions, feel free to interrupt me at any time.
- Please interrupt me, if there is something which needs clarifying. Otherwise, there'll be time for discussion at the end.
- If you have any questions you'd like to ask, I'll be happy to answer them.
- If you don't mind, we'll leave questions till the end.
- There will be time for questions after my presentation.

EFFECTIVE OPENINGS

- To make an effective presentation, it is important to get your audience interested in the first three minutes of your presentation. You need to hook your audience and cause them to pay attention to you. There are three ways to make an effective opening:
- 1. Give your listeners a problem to think about.
- 2. Give them some amazing facts.
- 3. Give them a story or some personal experience.

A problem

- Suppose your company lost 30% of its customer base over a three-month period because a competitor introduced a new product with some new exciting features. How would you respond to this situation?
- How many of you have ever had trouble remembering words? Just about everyone, right? Well, imagine a small machine that can read your mind. When you think of a Chinese word or phrase, the machine will wirelessly transfer the correct English word or phrase to your mind. Do you think that's possible?

Amazing facts

- According to a new study, the virus causing the bird flu sweeping Asia actually started in China over one year ago. An ineffective vaccine was given to chickens. Thinking the chickens were healthy, chicken farmers exported their chickens throughout Asia for a year without knowing that many of them carried the bird flu virus.
- Statistics show that 1 in every 4 Americans have appeared on television and 85% of couples who lose a child (through an accident or a health problem) get divorced.

A story

- You may have heard about the 16-year-old girl from Russia who has the ability to "see" broken bones or other medical problems inside people's bodies without the help of any instrument.
- Have you ever been in a situation where you wanted to change some personal habit or some physical characteristic? I remember when I was 40 years old and still weighed 50 kg and wanted to gain weight. A psychic (fortune-teller) told me to talk to the cells in my body before every meal and ask them to hold on to my food longer after I ate. I did it for six months and it turned out that at the end of six months I had gained 6 kg - the first weight I had gained since high school. (This is a true story.)

Problem technique

- Suppose . . . . How would you . . . ?
- Have you ever wondered why it is that . . . ? You have? Well, if I could show you . . . would you be interested?
- How many of you have ever . . . ? Do you think that's possible?

Amazing facts technique

- Did you know that . . . ?
- According to a new study . . . .
- Statistics show that . . . .
- I read somewhere the other day that . . . .
- Story/anecdote technique
- You may have heard about . . . .
- Have you ever been in a situation where . . . ? I remember

Transition Phrases to confirm Understanding:

- Are we all on the same page?
- Have I made everything clear?
- Are there any (more, further) questions?
- Are we all on the same page? I'd be happy to clarify anything that's not clear.
- Are there any further questions? Let's take a look at a few examples to help clarify.
- Before I move on, are there any questions?
- Does this all make sense to you?
- Is everyone still with me?
- Are you all following me so far?

Summarizing a point

- Before I move on, I'd like to recap the main points.
- Let me briefly summarize the main issues.
- I'd like to summarize what I've said so far...
- Moving to the next point
- This leads directly to my next point.
- This brings us to the next question.
- Let's now move on to/turn to...
- Let's now take a look at...
- Okay, let me now turn to the issue of...

Transition Phrases:

- Now, to change gears…
- Let's move on to the next item…
- To give you some background…
- Let's move on to…
- Turning our attention now to…
- I'm just going to run through the main points…
- Before we move on, I think we need to look at…
- That being said…
- In similar fashion…
- Looking at the time frame of what we have…

- I'd like to expand on…
- Let me elaborate further…
- As I said at the beginning, …
- This relates to what I was saying earlier…
- This ties in with…

Highlighting information

- I'd like to stress/highlight/emphasize the following points.
- I'd also like to draw your attention to the upper half of the chart.
- If you look at it more closely, you'll notice there are several surprising developments.
- I'd like to point out one or two interesting details.
- I'd like you to think about the significance of this figure here.
- I'd like to focus your attention on the underlying trend here.
- Whichever the reasons for this/Whichever way you look at it/However you try to explain it, the underlying trend is obvious.
- The interesting/significant/important thing about.... is....

Transition Phrases from a Prior Speaker:

- Building off of what s/he indicated…
- We need to keep in mind…
- We are really getting some traction on…
- I want to highlight the importance of…
- I want to emphasize the importance of…
- There will be more to come on that as we…
- That's an excellent point,
- If I may comment on the last piece there…
- Okay, I think we are all on the same page here…
- Yes, I get what you're saying…
- From our departments' perspective…

Conclusion Phrases:

- And finally we'll look at…
- To conclude, we'll touch on…
- In conclusion, let me sum up my main points.
- Well, that brings me to the end of my presentation, thanks so much for listening.
- Well that's it from me. Thanks a lot.
- It was a real pleasure being here today. Goodbye and thank you.
- Thank you for your attention. Now I am happy to answer any questions you might have.
- I'm now approaching/nearing the end of my presentation.
- Well, this brings me to the end of my presentation/talk.
- That covers just about everything I wanted to say about...

- As a final point, I'd like to...
- Finally, I'd like to highlight one key issue.
- That completes my presentation.
- Summarizing points
- Let me just run over/through the key points again.
- To conclude/In conclusion, I'd like to...
- In short/In a word/In a nutshell/In brief/To sum up/To summarize, it is generally/widely accepted/argued/held/believed that...
- First we looked at... and we saw that... . Then we considered... and we argued... .
- I'll briefly summarize the main issues.
- Therefore/Thus/On this basis/Given this, it can be concluded/deduced/inferred that...
- From the table/figures/data/results/information, it can be seen/concluded/shown/estimated/calculated that...

EFFECTIVE CONCLUSIONS

Using questions

- After all, isn't that why we're here?
- Let me just finish with a question: If we don't do it, won't somebody else?
- So, do we really want to miss this opportunity to get ahead of our competitors?

Quoting a well-known person

- To quote a well-known scientist, ...
- As... once said, ...
- To put it in the words of..., ...
- I'd just like to finish with something former US president Bill Clinton once said: 'You can put wings on a pig, but you don't make it an eagle'.

Referring back to the beginning

- Remember what I said at the beginning of my talk today? Well, ...
- Let me just go back to the story I told you earlier. Remember, ...
- Let me go back to the story I told at the start of my talk. Remember, the sales meeting in Vienna with the disappointed Japanese businessmen? So, this just shows you that knowing your entire product range is the key to success.

Calling the audience to action

- So that's the plan. Now let's go and put it into practice!
- So now it's your turn.
- Now let's make a real effort to achieve this goal!